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March 2, 2026

Search Committee
Paul H. Nitze School of Advanced International Studies
Hopkins-Nanjing Centre

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Resident Professor of International Economics position at the Hopkins-Nanjing Centre. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My research and teaching focus on macroeconomics, political economy, and financial markets, with particular attention to inequality, institutional trust, and the distributional consequences of economic policy.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In related work using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how institutional trust influences income growth and asset returns. These projects engage broader questions central to international political economy and development: how institutions shape economic opportunity, how financial systems allocate capital, and how policy design influences long-run growth and distributional outcomes.

At SAIS and particularly at the Hopkins-Nanjing Centre, I would be eager to teach courses in international political economy, global macroeconomics, development economics, and environmental political economy. My work lends itself naturally to themes at the intersection of global markets, institutional development, and sustainability. I am especially interested in exploring how energy transitions, financial globalization, and evolving supply chains affect emerging and advanced economies differently, and how China's economic trajectory interacts with global macroeconomic dynamics. The HNC's unique bilingual and binational setting provides an exceptional platform for engaging these themes in a comparative and globally grounded way.

I value graduate-level teaching and thesis advising. My approach emphasizes structured analytical reasoning, engagement with primary data and policy debates, and careful integration of theory and empirical evidence. In a residential and tightly knit academic community such as HNC, I would welcome the opportunity to mentor MAIS students closely, facilitate dialogue across perspectives, and contribute to a culture of academic rigor and intellectual openness.

The Hopkins-Nanjing Centre's longstanding commitment to academic freedom, interdisciplinary

engagement, and cross-cultural exchange is particularly compelling. I am enthusiastic about collaborating with colleagues across SAIS's Washington and Bologna campuses and contributing to research initiatives that bridge economic, environmental, and geopolitical questions. The opportunity to base research and teaching in Nanjing while maintaining strong global linkages aligns closely with my scholarly interests in international and institutional economics.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this role because:

1. My research connects macroeconomics, political economy, and institutional development.
2. I am prepared to teach graduate-level courses in international economics and advise research theses.
3. I value globally oriented, interdisciplinary academic communities that foster open and rigorous debate.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would be honored to contribute to the Hopkins-Nanjing Centre and the broader SAIS community.

Sincerely,

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